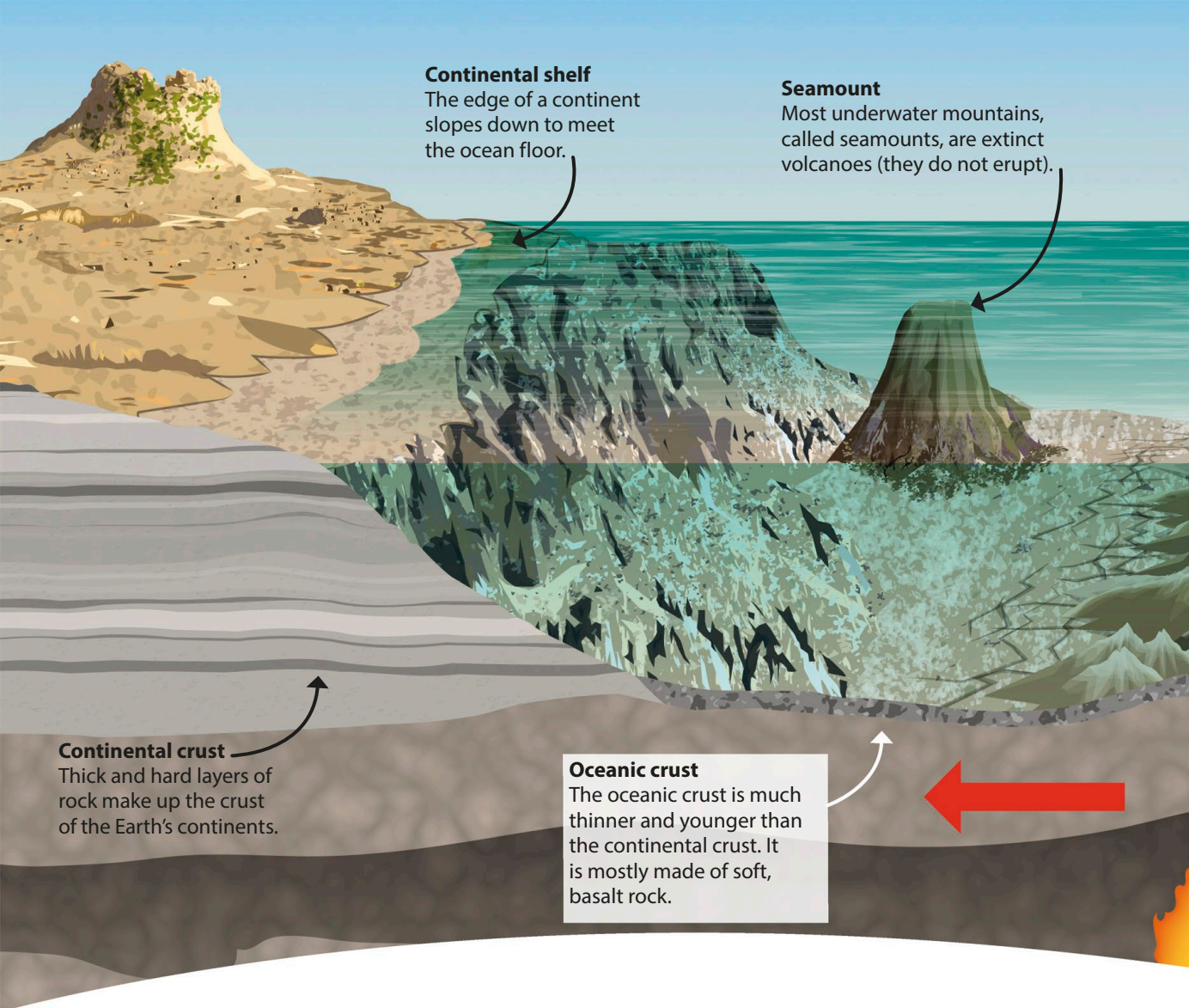




Continental shelf
The edge of a continent slopes down to meet the ocean floor.

Seamount
Most underwater mountains, called seamounts, are extinct volcanoes (they do not erupt).

Continental crust
Thick and hard layers of rock make up the crust of the Earth's continents.

Oceanic crust
The oceanic crust is much thinner and younger than the continental crust. It is mostly made of soft, basalt rock.

Ocean floor

A trip down to the ocean floor reveals a fascinating underwater landscape. This bumpy ocean floor has many features similar to dry land. There are steep slopes, deep cracks, and rising mountains. But there is one big difference—there's no light down here.

